

For the purpose of this letter, the actual name was replaced with “Candidate”.

To whom it may concern,

It is my pleasure to recommend Candidate for admission to MPhil ‘Economic and Social History’ at the University of Cambridge.

I met Candidate in early 2017, when he reached out to me via email to discuss my unpublished MA, a topic I specialize in - Polish Prison subculture ‘Grypsera’. We quickly found common ground as not many students have a very keen interest in this unique, not commonly researched topic.

Throughout the years I have known him, Candidate has built up a vast knowledge about the history of Polish Grypsera. Alongside me, he has met with former convicts, interviewed prison guards and studied the unique prison jargon- which in my opinion, he has become a somewhat expert and is fluent in. Last summer, Candidate became my fellow researcher when we decided to work together on an article concerning Polish Grypsera. Even though our co- operation was constrained by the COVID pandemic, working with Candidate has been nothing but delightful. He has proven to be very resourceful, diligent and highly intelligent. Furthermore, his research and communication skills (which are a necessity for a research of Grypsera), have surpassed my expectations.

As he embarked on his journey to Cambridge, he approached me with his research proposal asking for a reference. The topic of his research proposal is out of the ordinary and fascinating. Since 2002, I have dedicated my life to researching this topic and the research that Candidate wants to explore is one that current literature concerning prison culture lacks. His thesis is interesting and undoubtably challenging, but I am certain Candidate is equipped to successfully carry it out.

As a University staff myself, I highly recommend Candidate to further his education at University of Cambridge. Candidate has the knowledge, work ethic and research skills to continue his education at one of the world’s best universities. His skills have been displayed perfectly by the fact that before obtaining his undergraduate qualifications, he already published two academic articles and is currently working on the third one with me.

Candidate is a wonderful, optimistic and charismatic young man. He is a true humanist who is passionate about history, politics, philosophy, sociology and arts- and his broad interests allow him to have a broad vision and often a deeper perspective about certain issues. I am certain he will be a great fit at your university.

If you have any further questions about Candidate, please do not hesitate to contact me.